

LedgersUSA Tax Planning Portal

Comprehensive Product Architecture & SaaS Blueprint

1. Executive Summary

The **LedgersUSA Tax Planning Portal** is a public-facing web platform designed to help business owners and individuals perform **do-it-yourself tax planning**, receive an initial strategy package, and then upgrade into a **reviewed, implementation-ready tax plan** supported by LedgersUSA professionals and specialist providers.

The portal has four primary business functions:

1. **Lead generation and monetization** through a paid diagnostic intake.
2. **Automated strategy scoring** based on client facts.
3. **Conversion to premium tax planning engagements** reviewed by LedgersUSA.
4. **Implementation enablement** through documents, calculators, workflows, and expert referrals.

This creates a hybrid model combining:

- SaaS-style intake and automation
 - advisory services
 - implementation resources
 - referral marketplace economics
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2. Core User Types

Public Visitor

A prospect browsing the public website.

Goals: - Learn about tax planning - Understand potential value - Start the diagnostic

Diagnostic User

A user who pays the initial fee and completes intake.

Goals: - Input tax facts - Receive initial strategy recommendations - Decide whether to upgrade

Planning Client

A user who upgrades to a reviewed plan.

Goals: - Receive vetted recommendations - Access implementation tools - Track progress
- Engage outside specialists where needed

LedgersUSA Reviewer / Admin

Internal team reviewing submissions.

Goals: - Review intake - Adjust strategy package - Release vetted plans - Monitor conversion and client progress

Expert Provider

A specialist who helps implement parts of the plan.

Examples: - payroll providers - business attorneys - estate attorneys - retirement advisors - bookkeepers - insurance specialists

Goals: - receive qualified referrals - present service profiles - support implementation

3. Product Modules

A. Public Marketing Website

Public-facing pages for traffic, education, and conversion.

B. Intake & Diagnostic Engine

Paid questionnaire and automated scoring engine.

C. Strategy Recommendation Engine

Rules-based engine recommending strategies based on inputs.

D. Client Portal

Secure dashboard for results, upgrades, resources, and tasks.

E. CPA Review Workspace

Internal LedgersUSA review queue and reporting tools.

F. Implementation Resource Library

Templates, calculators, checklists, and compliance packages.

G. Expert Marketplace

Directory of providers organized by specialty and geography.

H. Analytics & Revenue Dashboard

Business reporting for diagnostics, upgrades, referrals, and revenue.

4. Recommended Website Information Architecture

Public Navigation

- Home
- How It Works
- Tax Strategies
- Pricing
- Resource Library
- Experts
- About LedgersUSA
- Start Diagnostic
- Log In

Tax Strategies Section

Each strategy gets its own SEO landing page.

Recommended pages: - Augusta Rule - Accountable Plan - S-Corp Optimization - Hiring Children - Vehicle Deduction Strategy - Solo 401(k) Optimization - SALT PTE Election - Donor-Advised Fund Strategy - Charitable Planning - Retirement Planning

Conversion Pages

- Diagnostic checkout page
 - Upgrade / planning engagement page
 - Schedule consultation page
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5. End-to-End User Journey

Phase 1: Discover

User finds the site via SEO, webinar, referral, or direct outreach.

Phase 2: Diagnostic Purchase

User pays an initial fee.

Suggested pricing: - Entry diagnostic: \$297 to \$597

Phase 3: Intake Completion

User provides: - personal tax profile - income profile - entity profile - business structure - implementation goals - planning qualifiers

Phase 4: Strategy Package Generation

System produces a preliminary package with: - recommended strategies - estimated savings range - suitability notes - next-step offer to upgrade

Phase 5: Upgrade to Reviewed Plan

User pays planning fee for LedgersUSA review.

Suggested pricing: - Starter plan: \$1,500 - Core plan: \$2,500 to \$3,500 - Advanced plan: \$4,000 to \$6,000 - VFO / premium: \$7,500+

Phase 6: LedgersUSA Review

Reviewer: - validates inputs - refines recommendations - adjusts assumptions - identifies missing information - approves final plan

Phase 7: Plan Delivery

Client receives: - vetted strategy report - implementation roadmap - resource access - provider referrals if needed

Phase 8: Implementation

Client either: - self-implements using portal resources, or - hires LedgersUSA / providers for support

Phase 9: Annual Renewal

Client returns each year for refreshed planning.

6. Intake Questionnaire Architecture

Section 1: Personal Profile

Fields: - first name - last name - email - phone - state of residence - marital status - tax filing status - dependents

Section 2: Income Profile

Fields: - W-2 income - business income - K-1 income - investment income - rental income - estimated total household income - estimated marginal tax bracket

Section 3: Business Profile

Fields: - business owner? yes/no - business type - entity structure - number of owners - annual business revenue - annual business profit - number of employees - bookkeeping status

Section 4: Tax Planning Qualifiers

Fields: - use of home for business meetings - home office use - children who can work in business - business vehicle use - retirement plan currently in place - charitable giving level - state income tax burden - real estate ownership - interest in advanced planning

Section 5: Goals & Priorities

Fields: - reduce current taxes - improve cash flow - build retirement savings - charitable planning - estate planning coordination - wealth building

Section 6: Uploads (optional initially, required for upgraded plans)

- prior year tax return
- current year financials
- payroll reports
- entity documents

7. Strategy Recommendation Engine

Approach

The portal should begin with a **rules-based recommendation engine**, which is easier to build, control, and audit than a fully AI-driven engine.

Each strategy receives a score based on: - eligibility - income suitability - entity type - implementation readiness - value potential

Example Scoring Logic

Augusta Rule

Trigger higher if: - entity is S-Corp or LLC taxed as S-Corp - client uses home for business purposes - income above threshold - books are reasonably organized

Accountable Plan

Trigger higher if: - S-Corp or employee-owner structure - home office or recurring owner-paid expenses - reimbursement opportunity exists

S-Corp Optimization

Trigger higher if: - Schedule C or single-member LLC - profit above threshold - owner not already optimized

Hiring Children

Trigger higher if: - business owner with children - age and work suitability present

Vehicle Strategy

Trigger higher if: - vehicle used in business - expected purchase or business-use vehicle exists

Retirement Optimization

Trigger higher if: - positive cash flow - high marginal tax rate - no existing plan or underfunded plan

SALT PTE Election

Trigger higher if: - pass-through entity - high-tax state - taxable income high enough to justify election

Donor-Advised Fund

Trigger higher if: - high-income taxpayer - charitable giving intent present

8. Strategy Output Structure

Each preliminary strategy recommendation should display:

- strategy name
- why it may fit
- estimated savings range
- complexity level
- documentation required
- whether LedgersUSA review is recommended before implementation

Example Output Card

Augusta Rule - Fit: High - Estimated savings potential: \$8,000 to \$25,000 - Best for: S-Corp owners who host legitimate business meetings at home - Complexity: Moderate - Review recommended: Yes

9. Client Portal Architecture

Dashboard

Client sees: - diagnostic status - upgrade status - plan status - recommended strategies - estimated savings range - outstanding tasks - unlocked resources

Strategy Workspace

Each strategy gets its own workspace with: - overview - eligibility notes - implementation steps - downloadable templates - calculators - FAQs - audit/compliance notes

Resource Library

Content types: - Word templates - Excel calculators - PDF explainers - checklists - implementation guides - sample completed documents

Task Management

Each plan should generate tasks, such as: - sign agreement - upload tax return - download board resolution - complete rent analysis - submit accountable plan reimbursements - choose payroll provider

Messaging / Notifications

System sends reminders for: - missing intake items - pending review - plan ready - implementation deadlines - annual renewal prompts

10. CPA Review Workspace

Admin Queue Fields

- client name
- diagnostic paid date
- entity type
- income band
- current status
- preliminary strategies
- assigned reviewer
- target completion date
- upgrade status

Reviewer Actions

- approve suggested strategy

- remove strategy
- add strategy
- edit assumptions
- upload final report
- release implementation access
- assign specialist referral

Outputs from Review

- reviewed plan summary
 - savings estimates
 - implementation sequence
 - document package unlocks
 - specialist referrals
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11. Expert Marketplace Design

Provider Categories

- payroll
- bookkeeping
- QBO setup/cleanup
- business attorney
- estate attorney
- retirement advisor
- insurance specialist
- valuation specialist
- real estate cost segregation specialist

Provider Profile Fields

- provider name
- category
- service specialties
- states served
- bio
- credentials
- website / booking link
- pricing model
- referral status
- LedgersUSA approved badge

Revenue Options

- referral fee
 - annual listing fee
 - lead fee
 - premium placement
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12. Core Data Model / Database Schema

Users

- user_id
- first_name
- last_name
- email
- phone
- role (prospect, client, admin, expert)
- created_at

Client Profiles

- profile_id
- user_id
- marital_status
- filing_status
- state
- dependents
- goals

Business Profiles

- business_id
- user_id
- business_name
- entity_type
- tax_status
- revenue
- profit
- employee_count
- bookkeeping_status

Diagnostics

- diagnostic_id
- user_id
- payment_status
- fee_paid
- intake_completed_at
- current_status
- score_summary

Strategy Recommendations

- recommendation_id
- diagnostic_id
- strategy_code
- score
- status (preliminary, reviewed, approved)
- estimated_savings_low
- estimated_savings_high
- reviewer_notes

Engagements

- engagement_id
- user_id
- package_type
- fee_amount
- agreement_status
- start_date
- completion_status

Documents

- document_id
- user_id
- strategy_code
- document_name
- file_url
- document_type
- uploaded_at

Tasks

- task_id
- user_id
- strategy_code
- task_name
- due_date
- status

Providers

- provider_id
- business_name
- category
- bio
- states_served
- approved_status
- contact_info

Referrals

- referral_id
 - user_id
 - provider_id
 - strategy_code
 - status
 - revenue_share
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13. Recommended Tech Stack

Front-End

- **Next.js** for website + app
- Tailwind UI / component system
- Vercel deployment

Authentication

- Clerk or Auth0

Database

- Supabase or Postgres

File Storage

- Supabase Storage or AWS S3

Payments

- Stripe

Forms / Workflow

- custom intake wizard in app
- optional embedded forms for MVP

CRM / Practice Management Integration

- HubSpot for marketing pipeline
- Financial Cents or equivalent for internal workflow

Email / Notifications

- Resend, Postmark, or SendGrid

Analytics

- Google Analytics
 - PostHog
 - Stripe revenue analytics
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14. Security & Compliance Considerations

Because this portal handles tax-related and potentially sensitive information, the platform should include:

- secure authentication
- encrypted file storage
- role-based access control
- secure payment processing
- terms of service and disclaimer language
- explicit statement that initial recommendations are not final tax advice until reviewed

Important legal distinction:

Diagnostic output should be framed as:

- preliminary strategy insights
- educational recommendations
- subject to review and validation

Final tax advice should be framed as:

- available only after engagement and review by LedgersUSA professionals
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15. Productized Service Packaging

Offer 1 — Tax Planning Diagnostic

Price: \$297 to \$597

Includes: - paid intake - strategy scoring - preliminary package - estimate of savings range

Offer 2 — Starter Review Plan

Price: \$1,500

Includes: - LedgersUSA review - basic strategy memo - implementation order - starter resources

Offer 3 — Core Planning Engagement

Price: \$2,500 to \$3,500

Includes: - reviewed package - documentation templates - implementation roadmap - access to calculators and tools

Offer 4 — Advanced Planning

Price: \$4,000 to \$6,000

Includes: - multiple strategies - quarterly touchpoints - retirement / charitable / entity coordination

Offer 5 — Premium / VFO Planning

Price: \$7,500+

Includes: - multi-entity planning - advisor coordination - year-round support - specialist introductions

16. MVP Build Roadmap

Phase 1 — MVP (Fastest Launch)

Build: - homepage - pricing page - intake wizard - Stripe checkout - rules-based strategy scoring - simple client dashboard - internal review tracker

Goal: Validate demand and conversion.

Phase 2 — Portal Expansion

Build: - resource library - downloadable documents - task tracking - reviewed plan delivery
- messaging / notifications

Goal: Increase upgrade conversion and client success.

Phase 3 — Expert Marketplace

Build: - provider directory - referral tracking - provider onboarding - premium listings

Goal: Create referral revenue and implementation support network.

Phase 4 — Automation & Scale

Build: - automated report generation - renewals - analytics dashboard - partner/franchise workflows - AI assistance for navigation and document routing

Goal: Scale across LedgersUSA channels and referral partners.

17. Revenue Model Summary

Direct Revenue

- diagnostic fee revenue
- planning upgrade revenue
- premium advisory revenue

Indirect Revenue

- expert referral revenue
- premium provider listings
- partnership/channel revenue
- renewal engagements

Example Annual Model

If 1,000 users buy the diagnostic at \$497: - revenue = \$497,000

If 12% upgrade to a \$2,500 plan: - 120 clients × \$2,500 = \$300,000

If expert referrals generate an additional \$50,000 to \$100,000: - total revenue potential exceeds \$800,000 annually before premium planning upsells

18. Recommended Deliverables for Next Design Sprint

Immediate Next Deliverables

1. site map
 2. user flow diagrams
 3. database schema diagram
 4. admin workflow diagram
 5. pricing page copy
 6. public homepage copy
 7. diagnostic questionnaire build spec
 8. strategy engine rules matrix
 9. portal dashboard wireframes
 10. expert marketplace wireframes
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19. Recommended Positioning Statement

LedgersUSA Tax Planning Portal helps business owners identify high-value tax strategies, receive expert-reviewed planning guidance, and implement those strategies through practical tools, templates, and trusted specialists.

20. Final Recommendation

The best way to launch is:

Start with an MVP that does three things well:

- collects paid diagnostic data
- produces compelling strategy recommendations
- converts users into reviewed planning engagements

Once those are validated, add: - implementation resource hub - expert marketplace - automation and renewals

This keeps the portal commercially practical while building toward a scalable SaaS-enabled advisory platform.